Where Are You? Start Here

A diagnostic flowchart for choosing your ocean account

◆ Your Policy Question

"How much ecosystem do we have?"

☐

EXTENT ACCOUNT

Map area (ha) of each ecosystem type. Track gains and losses over time.

"How healthy is our ecosystem?"

★

CONDITION ACCOUNT

Measure key indicators against a reference benchmark. Score 0 to 1.

"What benefits do people get?"

♦

SERVICES ACCOUNT

Quantify flows of goods and services from ecosystems to people, in physical and monetary terms.

⚙ What data do you have?

☐

Pathway A

No primary data

Use global open datasets and literature values. A valid Tier 1 account.

☑

Mix A + B

Some data available

Combine global datasets with national statistics and local reports.

☒

Pathway B

Field data exists

Primary surveys, monitoring programs, or high-resolution imagery available.